

1.4.1 Some asides...

Did you know that most servers today run on Linux? That means there's a good chance there's Linux somewhere behind all those Web pages you see.

Linux is not just an OS you use at home *instead* of Windows; a whole range of enterprise suites are now based on the Linux platform. From network servers to Web servers, several places have Linux as the backbone.

There are countless brains at work who pursue the technology—not for money, but out of sheer interest and passion. Linux boasts of some of the best online peer support today.

So how would you say “Linux”? As is usually the case with names, Linux too is not pronounced in any one particular way. While some say it as 'Li-nix' - Li as in leave and nix as in UNIX. Others mostly call it... LIH-nucks with the first syllable stressed. The “li” is said as in “limit” or “linger.”

For those of you wondering who came up with the penguin called Tux, the Linux mascot, it was someone called Larry Ewing.

Why a penguin, you might wonder. It was simply because Torvalds loves penguins! There's another reason for Torvalds choosing the penguin as the mascot for Linux. In his words,

“Having a penguin as a logo also gives more freedom to people wanting to use linux-related material: instead of being firmly fixed with a specific logo (the triangle, or just “Linux 2.0” or some other abstract thing), using something like a penguin gives people the chance to make modifications that are still recognizable.”

So you can have a real live penguin on a CD cover, for example, and people will get the association. Or you can have a penguin that does something specific (a Penguin writing on wordperfect for the WP Linux CD, whatever—you get the idea).